

Bhanu Prakash Srivastava's favourites

- Fav book - The Goal
- Fav food - Puri-sabji
- Fav singer - Mukesh Kumar
- Fav actor - Amitabh
- Fav actress - Rekha
- Fav movies - Baghban, Zanjeer
- Fav villain - Amjad Khan
- Cars or bikes - Cars
- First car - Maruti 800
- Fav car - Cars are only for utility
- Fav sport - Cricket
- Fav cricketer - Sunil Gavaskar

scenario. To remain on par with the current industry standards, meeting the stakeholders' expectations, and continuously striving for innovation towards achieving self-reliance in defence brings its own challenges. I feel proud to have an energetic workforce at BEL who selflessly keep pursuing these goals," says Srivastava.

Leading BEL requires extensive travel to meet stakeholders across the country. Srivastava's travel schedule is often gruelling. He shrugs off his Staff Officer's suggestions for a more relaxed travel plan or to sub-delegate/reschedule back-to-back meetings. Srivastava says that it's part of life and keeps up a hectic schedule to meet stakeholders and ensure that BEL is in the forefront.

Ramayana, Mahabharata, and the vision of BEL

If you ever encounter Srivastava, you will find a man who is spiritually strong. He often recites verses and quotes from Ramayana and Mahabharata to elucidate present-day events. The focal point of these two revered literary works for him is not just admiring one character, but rather every character described.

"There is something to learn from every character. You can glean lead-

ership from Lord Rama, while Shri Krishna can impart the right set of values necessary for being an excellent advisor. Similarly, focus can be gleaned from the mighty Hanuman, and the importance of experience can be imbibed from Jamwant. The list goes on," he says, with hands folded in respect.

Blessed with a family comprising a daughter, a son, and a caring wife, Srivastava credits his achievements to his better half, Alka. "I owe everything to her decision to be a homemaker. She has singlehandedly managed our kids most of the time. Despite my late nights at BEL, she ensured my absence never adversely affected Yash and Payal!"

With just over a year left until his retirement, Srivastava is uncertain about his plans post BEL. "I have never given it much thought. But everyone needs a break, and I believe my break is approaching in a few months. I want to spend more time with my family, and even start working on my PhD," he jokes with a mix of emotions in his eyes.

For now, he aims to steer BEL towards a path that leads to a larger share of civilian electronics, considering that Defence currently contributes over 90% of BEL's revenue. He also intends to ensure that BEL remains profitable in the years to come.

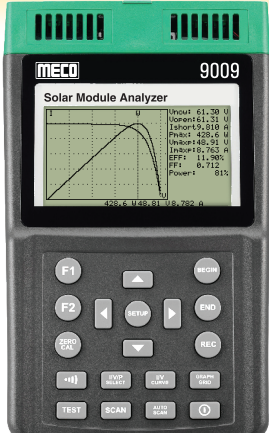
"I joined BEL out of love and respect for the nation, but I stayed with BEL because I wanted to contribute to India's self-reliance in defence electronics. Moving forward, I see BEL expanding and excelling in the export market," he concludes, "I hope to impart my learnings to the younger generation after my retirement."

Interestingly, his teachers from school days used to urge him to share lessons he had mastered with his fellow students. Perhaps India will have another teacher who imparts wisdom more from experiences and less from books! **EFY**



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